

First, you need to specify the table to be deleted. For this, you need to run the `SHOW is DATABASES;` command. The output of this command will show all the available databases.

Then, you can select the database and run the `SHOW is TABLES;` command to view its contents. Each database has multiple tables in it, hence you need to note down the exact name of the table you want to delete. Now that you've identified the table to delete, you can run the following command by placing the name of the table in the place of "table_name".

- `DROP TABLE table_name ;`

And, that's it! You've successfully deleted the table from the database. And, you can view the output of this process when it displays as Query OK. It shows that the table was deleted permanently and there were no errors encountered in the process.

However, it is important to note that removing or deleting an existing table leads to permanent data loss. There is no backup where you can retrieve the deleted table. Hence, you must take cautionary steps while deciding whether or not to delete a particular table. In addition to this, the deleted table can impact the database where it was stored. While retrieving the information from a specified database, you may not be able to procure all the data accurately due to the absence of some tables (deleted tables). This can further create several problems and "missing data" errors while using the retrieved data for software applications.

In this chapter, you've learned the role of tables in MySQL RDBMS and how they help store and retrieve data in an organized manner. The chapter also discussed the key types of data and their categories supported by MySQL tables. After that, the process of creating a table and deleting tables were explained. Now, you're ready to head to the next chapter which discusses the core operations involved in using MySQL. These operations, called Create, Read, Update, and Delete (CRUD), can showcase the web application uses of MySQL and how you can maintain databases effectively with it. **d**